# Interview Questions for Vi Wickam

Fiddler, singer, and teacher, Loveland, Colorado · Digital marketing strategist, Wickam Group

> **How this works:** answer in writing or by voice note, whichever is easier. Answers don't need to be polished, and you can skip any question. I'll shape them into a piece for the blog.
>
> Voice notes from your phone's voice memo app are perfect. Send them as replies or through a Google Drive link.

**01** You've been playing fiddle since you were a kid, and you're a third generation fiddler. What was music like in your house growing up, and what was it like playing with your dad and brothers in the Wickam Family Band on *Blinky's Fun Club*?

**02** You can play almost anything you've heard from memory, and people at weddings love trying to stump you. How did you build that ear, and what's the hardest request anyone has thrown at you?

**03** You sing as well as fiddle. When did singing become part of what you do on stage, and how does it change the way you connect with a crowd?

**04** You've been a finalist at the Grand Masters' Fiddler Championship and placed at the National Oldtime Fiddlers' Contest in Weiser. What does preparing for a contest round look like, and what keeps you going back to Weiser?

**05** You've also said contest fiddling isn't the end-all be-all. What do you hope students take away from fiddling that has nothing to do with winning?

**06** You founded myTalentForge.com with hundreds of fiddle lessons online. What did you learn building an online music school, and what would you do differently if you started it today?

**07** Your website calls you "57.3% Nerd. 61.9% Artist." How do marketing and music feed each other for you, and has being a performer made you a better marketer?

**08** You've played with Steve Eulberg in Fiddle Whamdiddle and jammed a lot with Daniel Delaney. As a drummer I'm always thinking about groove. Who sets the feel when you play with others, and what makes a great accompanist?

**09** Running a business by day and playing music by night is a lot. Was there a setback or a rough stretch, in music or in work, that taught you something you still lean on?

**10** Any advice for younger people like me who are interested in getting into the music industry?

Thank you, Vi. No rush at all. **Damon**, The Session Notes